



WORLD HAPPINESS REPORT

Data Analytics — Stage 0

First Insights & Visual Thinking

Dataset: World Happiness Report 2015–2019 | **Source:** Kaggle / Gallup World Poll

 158 Countries · 5 Years of Data · 6 Variables Analyzed

THE DATASET

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What is the World Happiness Report?

An annual Gallup World Poll measuring self-reported well-being across nations. Countries score 0–10 on a 'Cantril ladder' life evaluation, aggregated from thousands of interviews per country.



2015–2019

Years



~158

Countries



0–10

Score Range



782

Total Records

6 KEY VARIABLES



GDP per Capita



Social Support



Healthy Life Expectancy



Freedom to Choose



Trust in Government



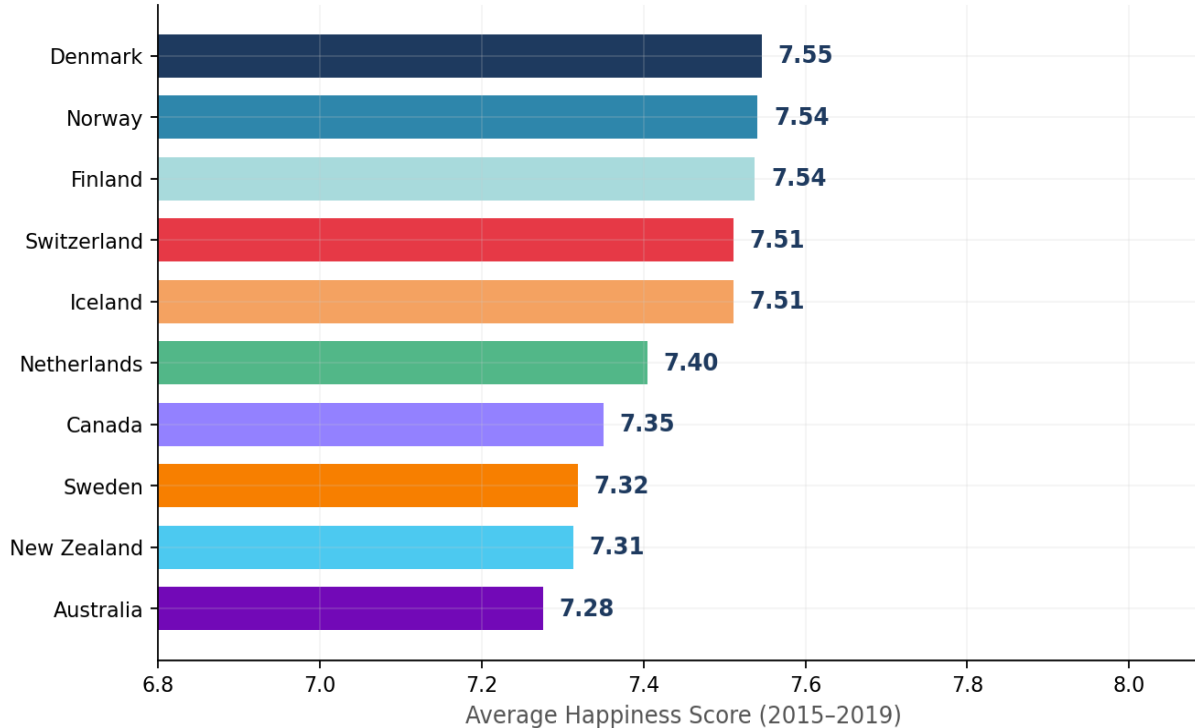
Generosity

First Glance: The dataset is clean and well-structured. Nordic nations cluster at the top consistently. Sub-Saharan Africa and war-torn nations score lowest. GDP, health, and social support are closely interlinked.

Q1: Which countries are consistently the happiest?

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Top 10 Happiest Countries (2015-2019 Average)



KEY INSIGHTS

#1

Denmark leads with a 5-yr avg of 7.55 out of 10



All Top 10 are in W. Europe, Oceania or N. America



Nordic model: social safety nets + strong freedom



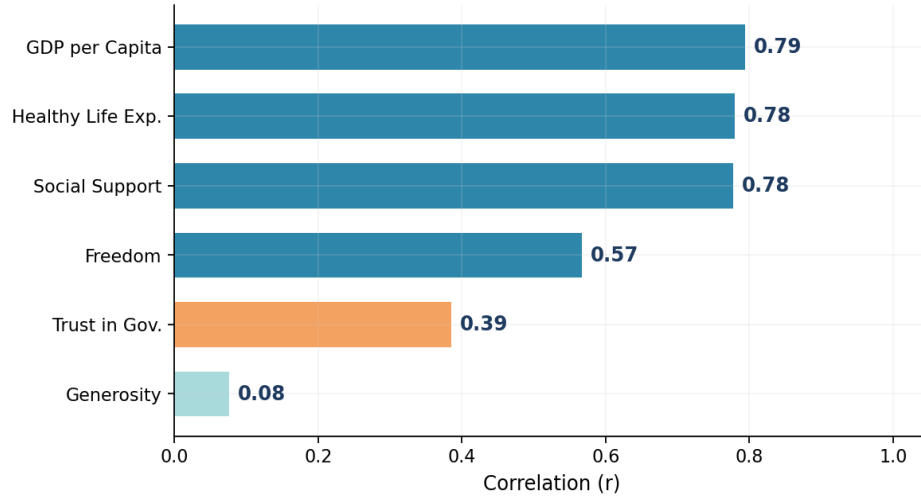
Top 10 cluster tightly (7.28-7.55); competitive race

Q2: What factors most strongly drive happiness?

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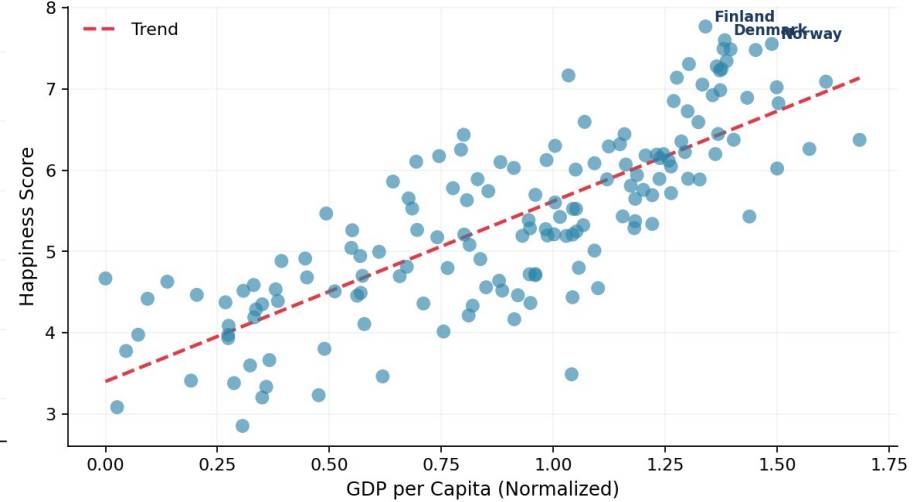
Correlation with Happiness Score (2019)

Happiness Factor Correlations (2019)



GDP per Capita vs. Happiness (2019)

GDP per Capita vs. Happiness Score (2019)



 **GDP: $r = 0.79$**

Wealthiest nations are happiest — strongest single predictor.

 **Health: $r = 0.78$**

Life expectancy and happiness are almost equally correlated.

 **Social: $r = 0.78$**

Having people to rely on matters as much as income.

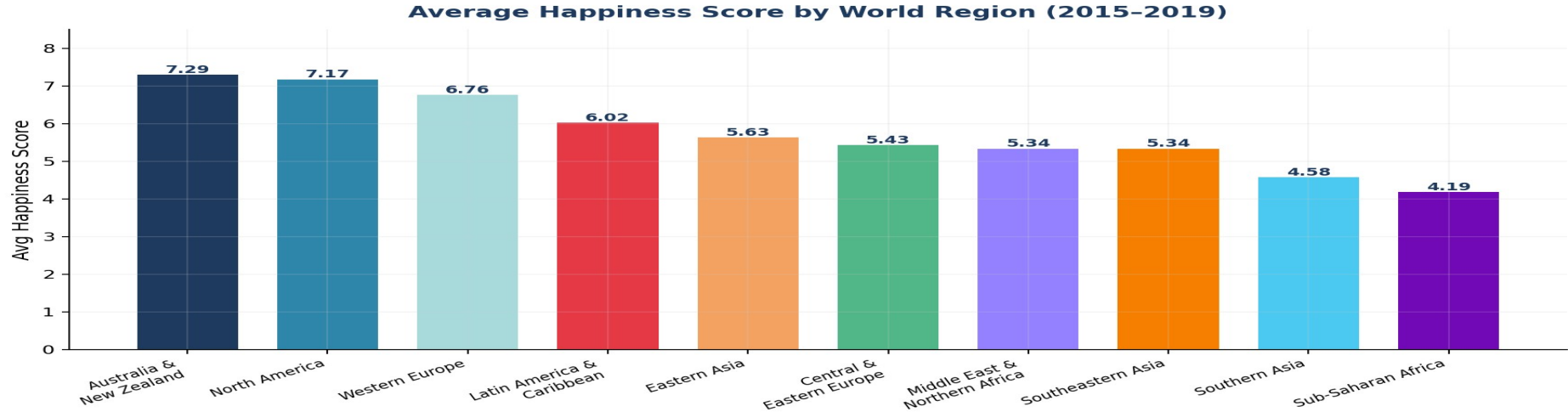
 **Generosity: 0.08**

Weakest link — giving behavior doesn't predict national score.

Q3: How does happiness vary by region and over time?

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Regional Average Scores (2015–2019)



Score Trends: Top 5 Nations



7.30

Oceania & N. Am.

6.76

W. Europe

4.19

Sub-Saharan Africa

KEY TAKEAWAYS & LIMITATIONS

01

Nordic nations lead the world

Denmark, Norway, Finland & Iceland have held the top 5 consistently from 2015 to 2019.

02

GDP + Health + Social = Happiness

These 3 factors explain most of the variance in happiness ($r > 0.77$ each), far outpacing trust and generosity.

03

A 4.47-point global divide exists

The happiness gap between richest and most deprived nations spans nearly half the entire 0–10 scale.

04

Global scores are remarkably stable

Average global happiness shifted by less than 0.05 points in 5 years — systemic drivers, not events, shape happiness.

LIMITATIONS

- Self-reported scores may carry cultural response bias
- Some regions have fewer countries, skewing averages
- 2017 data lacks region labels — mapped from 2015–16
- 5-year window may miss longer economic policy cycles
- Correlation $\neq$ causation: GDP links don't prove GDP causes happiness